if they knew they could get the same deal. Plus, any kind of amnesty or plea deal depended on the return of documents, which Snowden repeatedly asserted he did not have.

In a CBS News poll conducted in January 2014, 61 percent of Americans thought Snowden should stand trial in the United States for his actions. Only 23 percent thought he should be granted amnesty.[17] Although public and official opinions were generally unfavorable toward Snowden, there was little doubt the

"WAR" ON WHISTLE-BLOWERS AND A DOUBLE STANDARD

After promising during his campaign that he would protect whistle-blowers, President Obama and his administration proceeded to prosecute government leakers at an unprecedented rate. As of March 2015, eight whistle-blowers had been prosecuted under the Espionage Act. That was more than double the rate of prosecutions of all previous administrations combined.

In 2015, retired general David Petraeus was accused of giving notebooks of classified information, including the names of spies and war strategy, to his mistress who was also writing his biography. Petraeus then lied to FBI interviewers about the facts of the case. He was charged with only a misdemeanor rather than indicted under the Espionage Act. Many consider this a double standard. Abbe Lowell, attorney for convicted whistle-blower Stephen Kim, wrote in a letter to the Department of Justice that high-level officials have been allowed to leak classified information with "virtual impunity."[18]

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